acts as a combined controller and view model for the Razor page. You will explore these files in detail in the next chapter.

Two other files sit in the Pages folder—one named _ViewStart.cshtml and another named _ViewImports.cshtml. Razor files named with a leading underscore are not intended to be rendered directly. These two files play an important role in the application, and they should not be renamed. The purpose of these files will be explained in the next chapter.

The Pages folder also contains a Shared folder. Within that are two further Razor files, both having leading underscores in their names. The _Layout.cshtml file acts as a master template for other files, containing common content, including the navigation you altered in the previous section. The other Razor file, *_ValidationScriptsPartial .cshtml*, is a partial file. *Partial files* are usually used to contain snippets of UI that you can plug into pages or layouts. They support HTML and Razor syntax. This particular partial file contains some script references to client-side validation libraries. You will work with these in chapter 5. The final file is a CSS stylesheet with an odd name: _Layout .cshtml.css. It contains style declarations that are applied to the _Layout.cshtml file. The naming convention is used by a new feature in .NET 6, called CSS Isolation. You will look at what this is and how it works in chapter 11.

2.2.7 The app-settings files

App-settings files are used as a place to store application-wide configuration settings information. The project template consists of two app-settings files: appSettings.json and appSettings.Development.json. The first, appSettings.json, is the production version that will be deployed with the published application. The other version is the one used when you are developing the application. The structure of the file contents is JSON.